



Tips & Tricks



Quick search

In the course of our daily work routines, a lot of replacement of text is used in our files (DB scripts, text files, log files, etc). The following commands help us to search for specific patterns in files under a folder and its sub-folders.

1. To search for files named, "myD*.sql":

```
find ~/dbScripts/ -name "myD*.sql"
```

where ~/dbScripts/ is the base folder to start scans for files matching myD*.sql

2. To search for the contents in files available in folders and sub-folders:

```
find ~/dbScripts/ -name "myD*.sql" -exec grep -l "find_value" {} \;
```

3. To search for and replace content in files available in folders and sub-folders:

```
find ~/dbScripts/ -name "myD*.sql" | xargs sed -i -e 's/oldvalue/newvalue/g'
```

(In some sed versions -i would not be supported)

The same can be done using Perl, but for that Perl has to be installed on your system

```
find ~/dbScripts/ -name "myD*.sql" | xargs perl -pi -e 's/oldvalue/newvalue/g'
```

...where g stands for replacing all occurrences in the file and s is used to consider files as separate rather than as a single file.

These scripts have proved to be very helpful in my work and you, too, can use these to solve many problems.

—Pranavam S, pranavam.s@gmail.com



Set your default gateway

Now you can quickly set the route for your machine from the terminal.

Start by opening up a terminal window. After making sure you have the IP address of your gateway to do so (in this case the gateway of 10.3.156.1 is being used), type in the following:

```
route add default gw 10.3.156.1 eth0
```

You can see the changes by typing the following:

```
route -n
```

You should always delete the default gateway, if there is any, before setting a new one. To do that, use the command given below:

```
route delete default gw <some_ip_addr> <device_name>
```

—Amit N. Bhakay, amitnb4u@aol.com



Keep logs longer using less space

Normally, logs rotate monthly, over-writing all the old data. Here's a sample "/etc/logrotate.conf" that will keep 12 months of back-up, compressing the logfiles.

Open your /etc/logrotate.conf in a text editor and make it look similar to what's shown below:

```
cat /etc/logrotate.conf
```

```
# see "man logrotate" for details
# rotate log files weekly
# chrtico changes to monthly
monthly
# keep 4 weeks worth of backlogs
# keep 12 months of backup
```